T2

T2 — Image and video candidates

Checkpoint: March 10, 2026

I've grouped the eight articles by topic below, with three choices each. The original publisher does not matter. I prioritized contemporaneous March 9–10 imagery and direct source links.

Note: These are relevant search results, not independently confirmed top-three Google Images rankings or completed VLM verification results.

1. France and allies prepare a defensive mission — Forbes Ukraine (Russian)



1. Macron aboard carrier

March 9 • Reuters

Article and photograph

2. French naval group

March 9 article

Article · Image



3. French Navy deployment

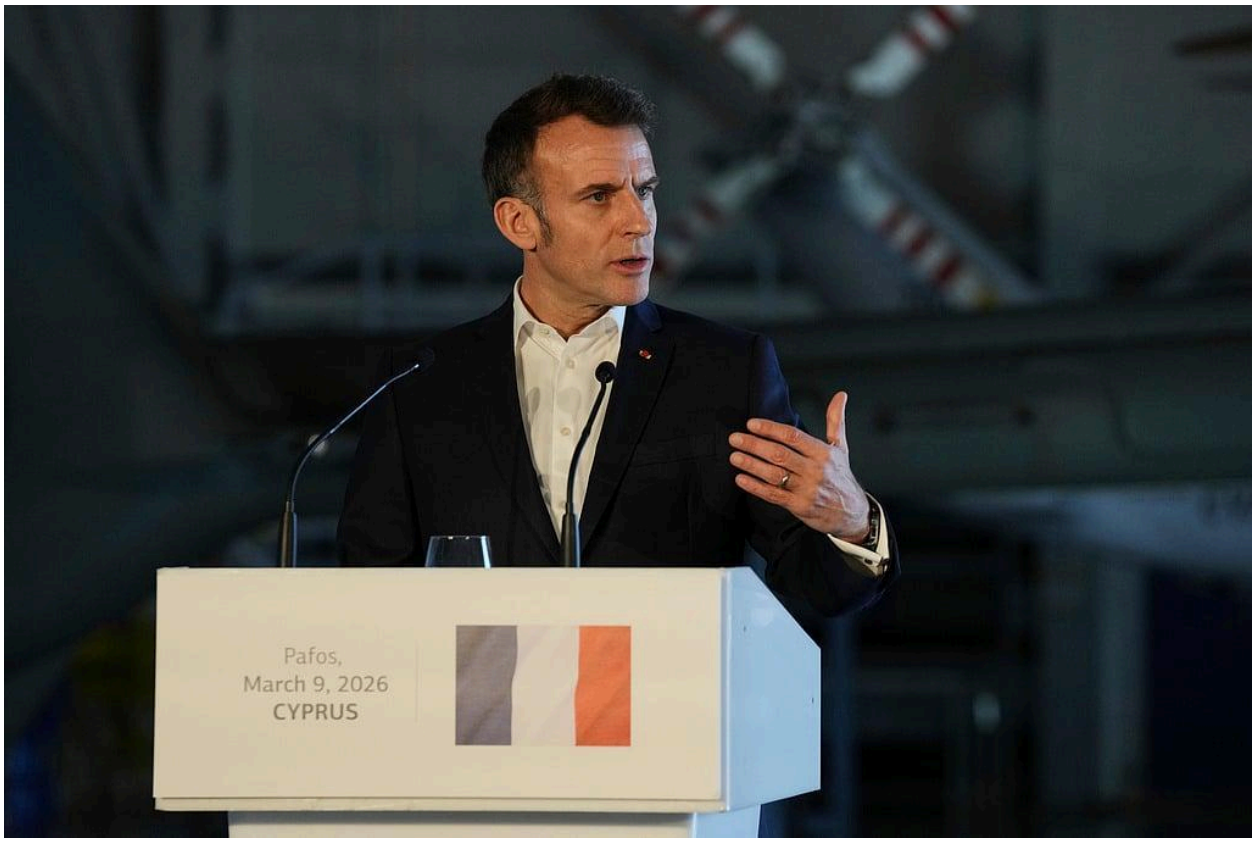
March 5 • French Navy

Article and photograph

These are good evidence of French military presence, but do not independently prove that Hormuz escorts had begun.

arabnews.pk
+1

2. Same French mission — Forbes Ukraine (Ukrainian edition)



1. Macron's announcement

Article and image



2. Carrier bridge visit

[Article and image]



3. Regional security meeting

Article and image

This is the same news event as article 1. Avoid treating the two language editions as independent evidence.

Al Jazeera
+2

3. Iranian Foreign Ministry calls Hormuz unsafe — Russia Today



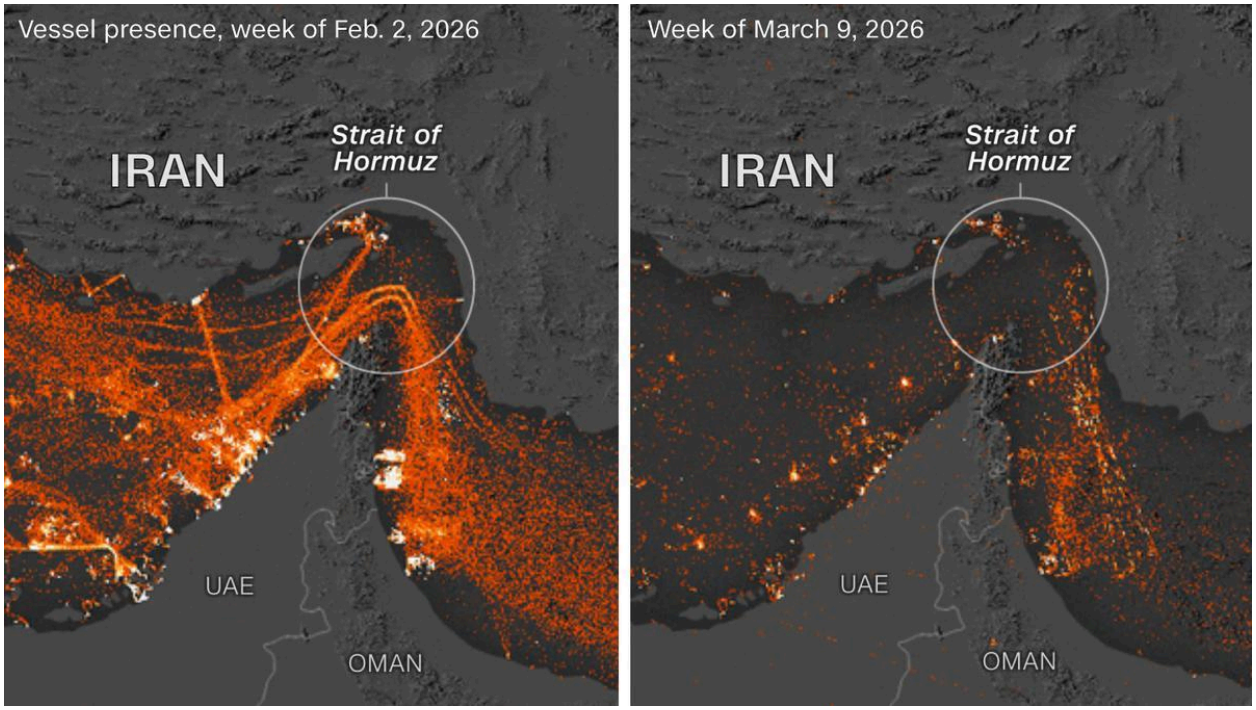
1. Ministry spokesperson

[Original article]



2. Tanker off Muscat

[Photo and article]



3. March 10 vessel map

[Traffic visualization]

Choice 1 is the most relevant to the attribution; the tanker and traffic images provide physical context. The USNI article was published March 11, so its March 10 map must be checked for availability at T2.

Al Jazeera
+1

4. Baghaei says Hormuz is unsafe — Ridus

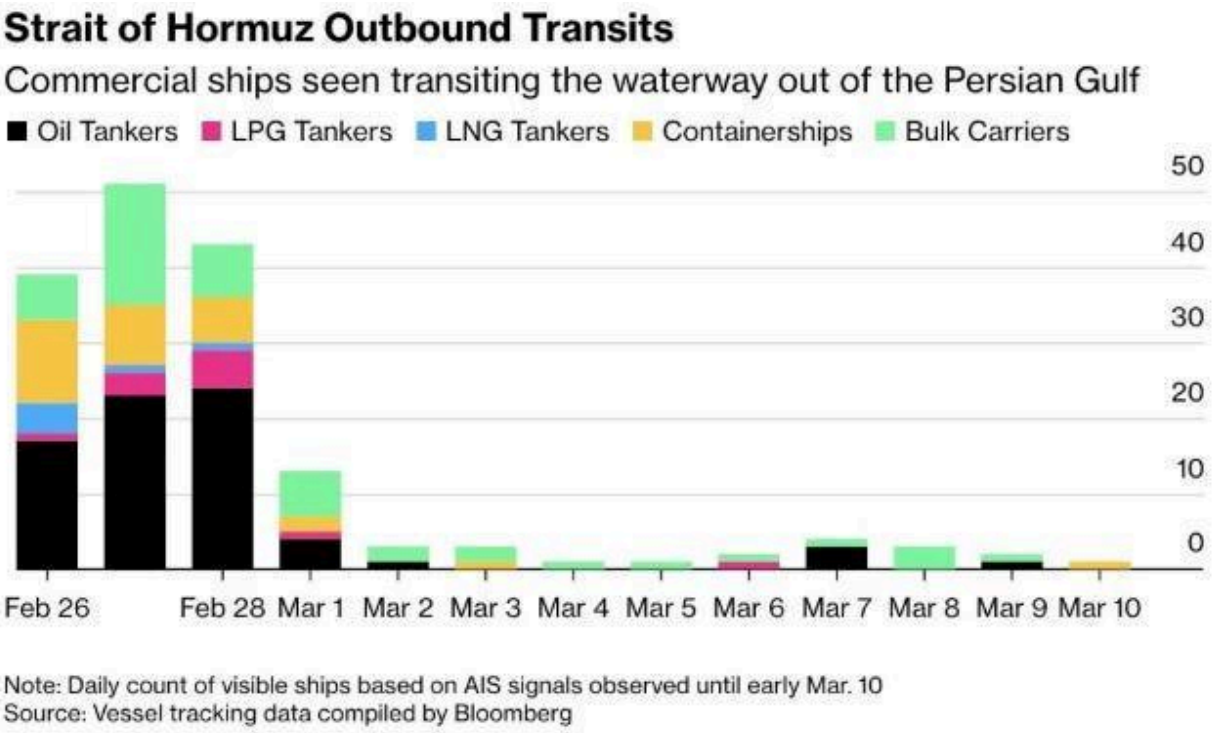


1. Baghaei speaking

Original article

2. Tankers at sea

Article · Image



3. Disrupted vessel movement

[Article and data]

The second image is contextual; the third provides reported vessel counts. Neither establishes what Baghaei said without accompanying text or audio.

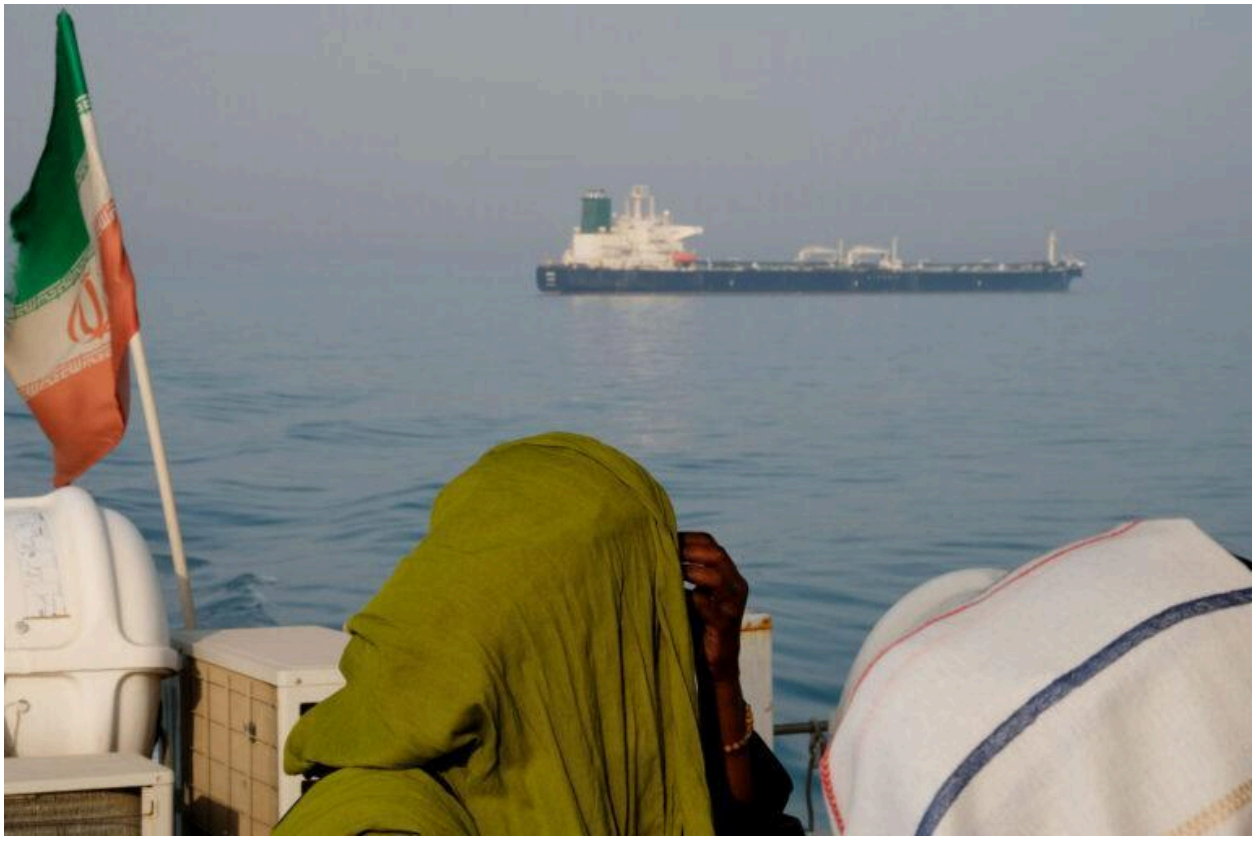
S&P Global

5. Iran considers tanker security fees — Forbes Ukraine (Russian)



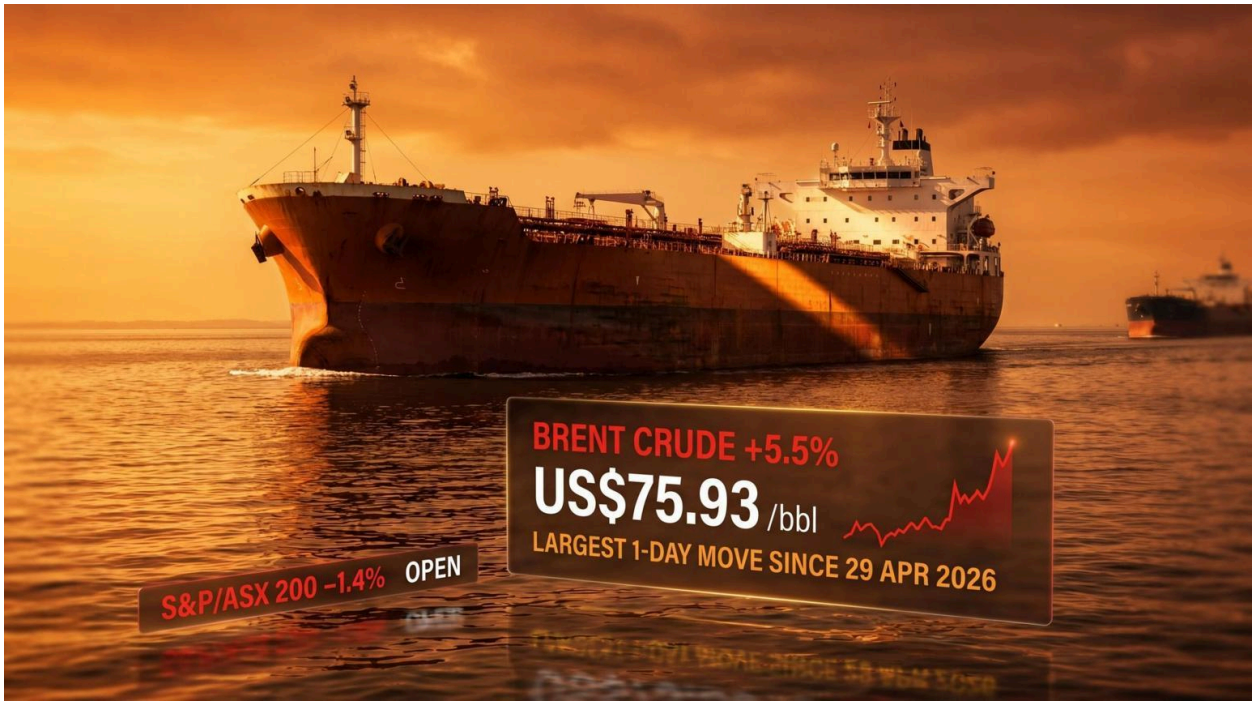
1. Anchored commercial ships

Reuters photograph



2. Security-fee report

[Article and media]



3. Hormuz tanker imagery

Article and illustration

The policy proposal is reported in the March 10 articles. An image of a tanker cannot verify the proposed fee, so these are useful candidates for testing an `INSUFFICIENT` visual-evidence result.

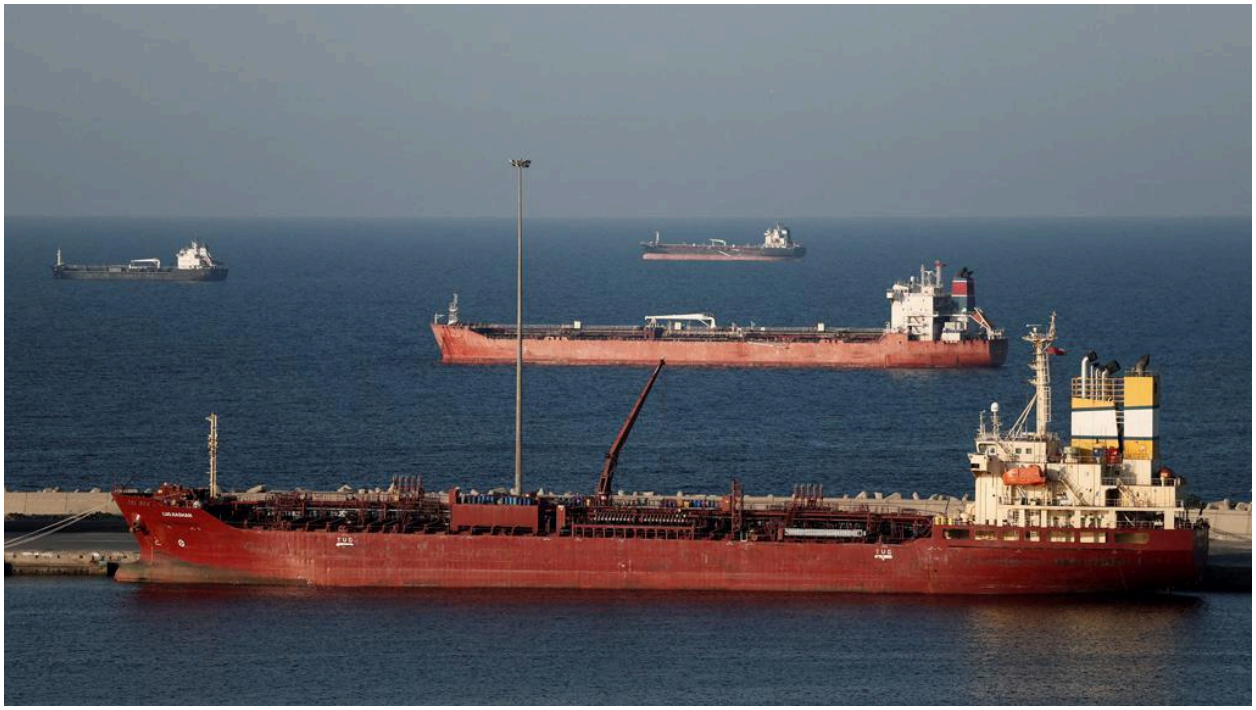
babel.ua
+1

6. Same proposed security fees — Forbes Ukraine (Ukrainian edition)



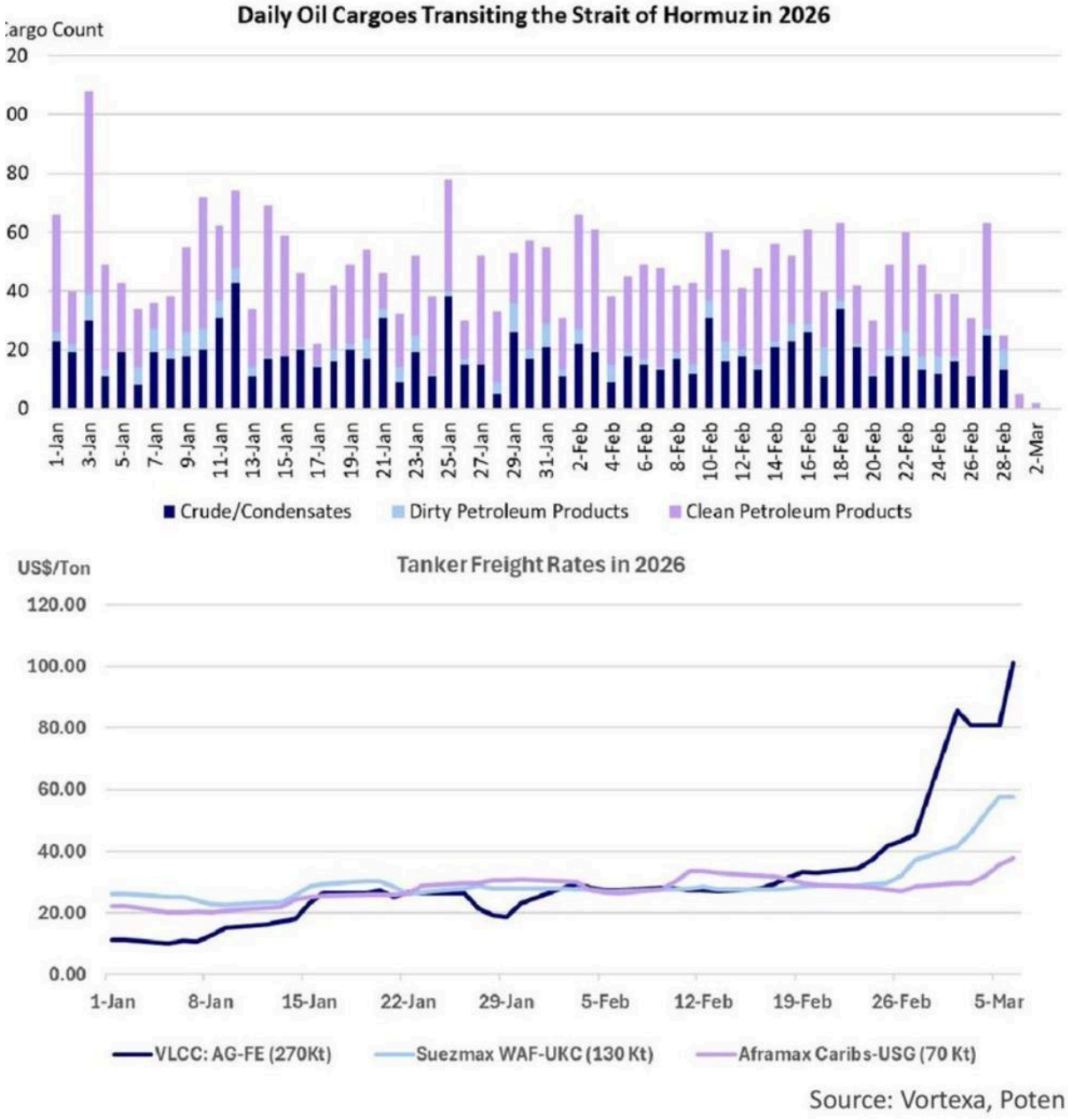
1. Report on planned fees

Article



2. Oil tanker at anchor

[CNN photo and article]



3. Original Ukrainian coverage

[Original article]

These overlap with article 5 because both refer to the same announcement. The Luojiashan photograph is explicitly identified in the CNN-linked source.

KESQ

7. U.S. vows to secure the Strait — Zee News



1. Hegseth at Pentagon

Official photograph



2. Disputed tanker escort

[Article and photograph]



3. U.S. military briefing

[Article and supporting images]

This topic has the strongest mismatch opportunity. On March 10, a U.S. official's claim that a tanker had received military escort was withdrawn and the White House denied that such an escort had occurred. It illustrates why a proposed security operation must not be confused with an operation already underway.

U.S. Department of War
+1

8. Iran says U.S.–Israeli actions made Hormuz unsafe — Tsargrad



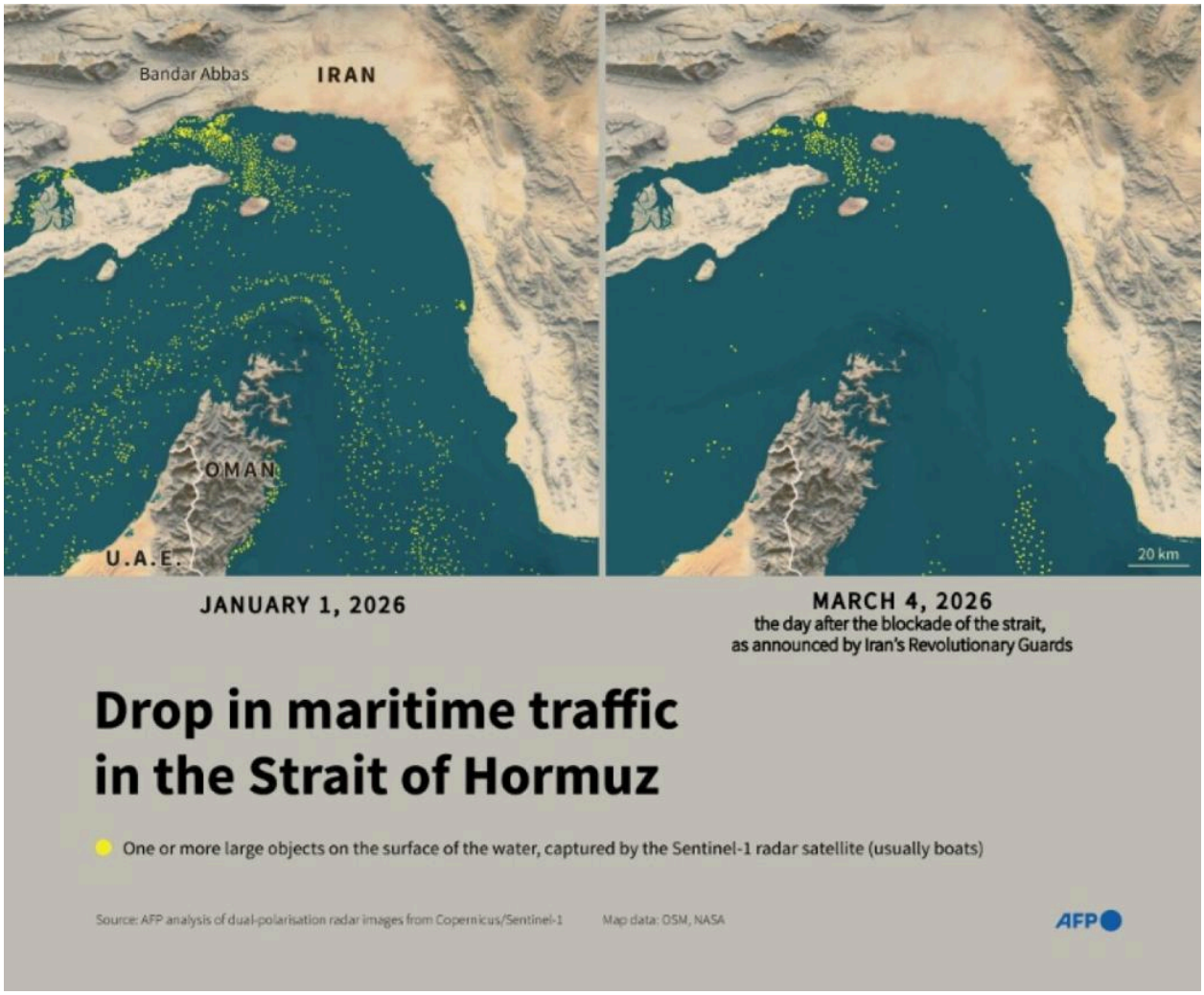
1. Foreign Ministry spokesperson

Original article



2. Ships anchored in Oman

[Photo and article]



3. Vessel-traffic conditions

[March 10 traffic data]

The last source reports three ships transiting on March 9, useful for showing a highly disrupted but not literally zero-traffic maritime state.

S&P Global

Best 5 candidates for Hao's T2 Evidence panel

I would prioritize these rather than cache all 24:

1. Macron aboard the Charles de Gaulle, March 9 — preparation for a proposed defensive mission.
2. Macron's Cyprus announcement, March 9 — evidence for the announcement, not operational escorts.
3. Reuters tanker photograph off Muscat, March 9 — shipping disruption context.
4. S&P Global March 9–10 maritime traffic data — quantitative grounding for constrained shipping.
5. March 10 disputed U.S. escort story — excellent hallucination/mismatch demonstration.

The image thumbnails above are search-based previews, so open each linked article and download the correctly captioned original media before using it. Some results are article links rather than confirmed direct image files. No VLM verification labels or confidence scores have been generated yet.

Also, the T2 report itself contains claims mostly about shipping disruption, threats and promised escorts—not completed escort missions. That distinction will make the live demo substantially more convincing.

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